and the 16 February terror attack that killed more than eighty, again mostly Shias, in Quetta's Hazara Town (International Crisis Group 2014b, p. i). In response to these attacks the Hazara community protested, refusing to bury their dead until the state provided protection to the community and punished the terrorists (BBC News 2013). The LeJ is mostly responsible for these attacks. '*The Lashkar–e-Jhangvi took responsibility for the attacks but where is the government. Why doesn't it do something? It is a government failure*' (Student, Female, Quetta). Because Balochistan borders on Iran, the province and its capital became a major SSP base, with LeJ leader Haq Nawaz Jhangvi moving to Quetta in the mid-1980s. The LeJ is now the most powerful sectarian organization in the city and province (International Crisis Group 2014, p. 18). According to the International Crisis Group, the TTP has attempted to 'woo Baloch dissidents, including by condemning the state's failure to recognise Baloch rights', but 'have found no takers within Baloch nationalist circles' (International Crisis Group 2014b, p. 20). However, TTP factions have targeted civilians in Quetta as well. Added to this cauldron of terrorist outfits is the appearance of Daesh in Pakistan around 2016. In 2016 seventy people were killed and ninety-two injured, in an attack that targeted lawyers who came together at the emergency department of a hospital when they accompanied the murdered body of their colleague (Al Jazeera 2016). A faction of the Pakistani Taliban, and Daesh, took responsibility for these attacks. One spokesperson for the Pakistan army claimed 'that the attack was aimed at undermining security in Balochistan in the light of China-Pakistan economic cooperation in the region' (Siddiqui and Dehghan 2016).

It is difficult to establish if it is despite or because of all of this that most of the young people who took part in the research support the Pakistani army and see the army as the only reliable institution: *'Army is everything here. The link between state and army is so vague. Foreign policy is run by the army'; 'Army is the only stable institution we have.*' One student did however qualify that there is an ethnic element that plays a part: '*The army, government state is made up of Punjabis.*'

For a majority of the participants the army is the one institution that they can trust. Only a few participants, in both private and government universities, acknowledged that there were instances where the army had overstepped by interfering in the democratic process, but this was often followed by the majority claiming that the army was left with no choice, given the corrupt state of Pakistani politics. In the case of Balochistan as pointed out earlier, the participants were unclear about the ground realities in the province, the result of an information blackout related to Balochistan. Any criticism of the army was an exception not